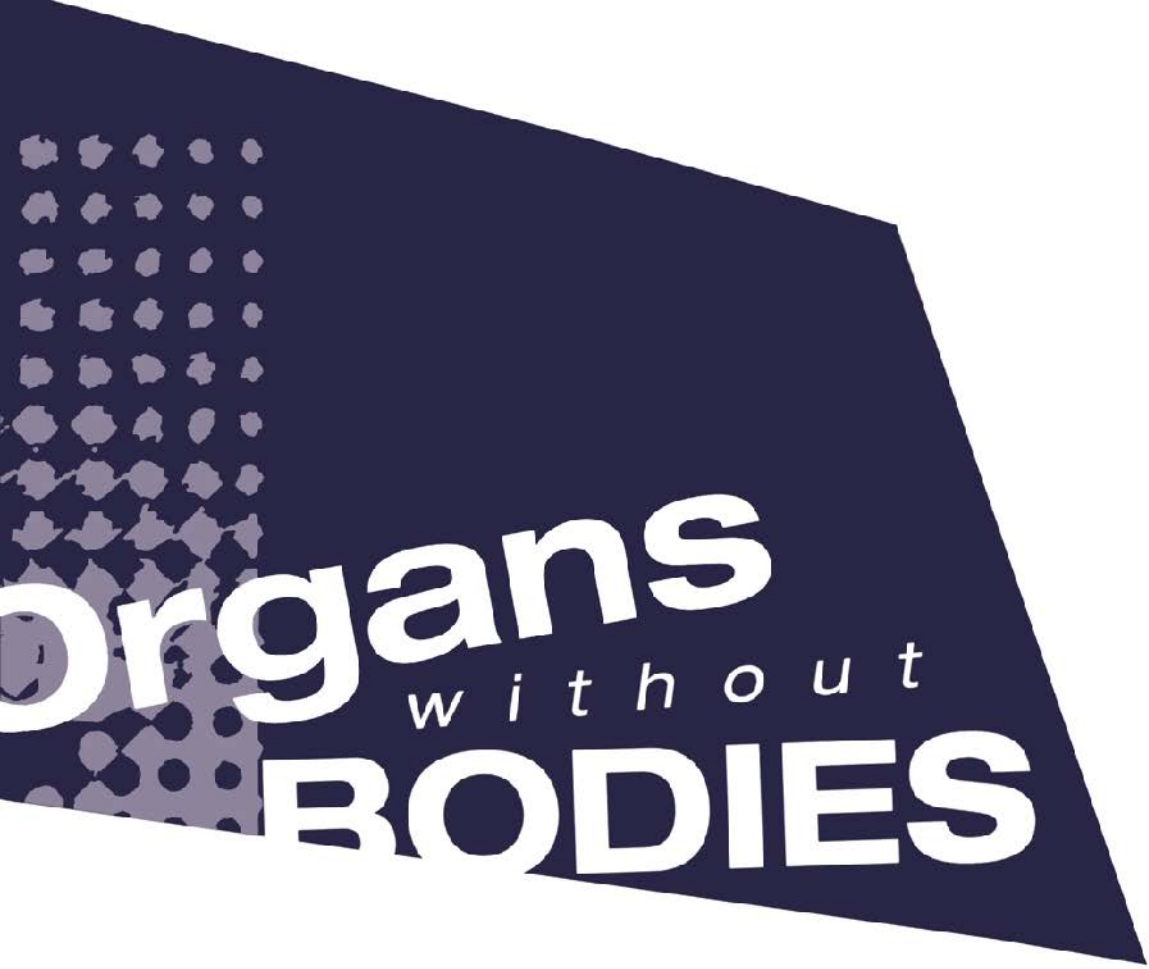


On Deleuze and Consequences

Slavoj Žižek

Organs without Bodies

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Deleuze and Consequences

Slavoj Žižek

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To Joan Copjec, with the coldness and cruelty of a true friendship

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Contents

Introduction: An Encounter, Not a Dialogue ix

DELEUZE

The Reality of the Virtual 3
Becoming versus History 9
"Becoming-Machine" 15
Un jour, peut-être, le siècle sera empiriomoniste? 19
Quasi-Cause 26
Is It Possible Not to Love Spinoza? 33
Kant, Hegel 41
Hegel 1: Taking Deleuze from Behind 45
Hegel 2: From Epistemology to Ontology . . . and Back 55
Hegel 3: The Minimal Difference 60
The Torsion of Meaning 74
A Comic Hegelian Interlude: Dumb and Dumber 77
The Becoming-Oedipal of Deleuze 80
Phallus 87
Fantasy 94
RIS 101

CONSEQUENCES

1 Science: Cognitivism with Freud 111
"Autopoiesis" 111
Memes, Memes Everywhere 118
Against Hyphen-Ethics 123
Cognitive Closure? 133
"Little Jolts of Enjoyment" 140

2 Art: The Talking Heads 149
Kino-Eye 151
Hitchcock as Anti-Plato 157
The Cut of the Gaze 163
When the Fantasy Falls Apart 168
"I, the Truth, Am Speaking" 170
Beyond Morality 177
3 Politics: A Plea for Cultural Revolution 183
A Yuppie Reading Deleuze 183
Micro-Fascisms 187
Netocracy? 192
Blows against the Empire 195
On the Permanent Actuality for Revolutionary Cultural Politics of President Mao Ze Dong's Slogan "Long Live the Great Proletarian Cultural Revolution" 203
Index 215

INTRODUCTION

An Encounter, Not a Dialogue

Gilles Deleuze was well known for his aversion toward debate—he once wrote that when a true philosopher sits in a café and hears somebody say "Let us debate this point a little bit!" he jumps up and runs away as fast as possible. He could have quoted as the proof of his attitude the entire history of philosophy. That Plato, the first true metaphysician, wrote dialogues is perhaps the greatest irony in the history of philosophy, since his dialogues never involve a symmetrical exchange of arguments. In the early dialogues, Socrates occupies the position of the one who "knows that he knows nothing," and, from it, undermines the presumed knowledge of his partners; in the late ones, the main character does all the talking while the partner's contribution is limited to occasional exclamations like "It is so!" "By Zeus, you are right!" and so forth. And, instead of bemoaning this fact, one should fully endorse and assume it. As Alain Badiou put it, philosophy is inherently *axiomatic*, the consequent deployment of a fundamental insight. Hence, all great "dialogues" in the history of philosophy were so many cases of misunderstanding: Aristotle misunderstood Plato, Thomas Aquinas misunderstood Aristotle, Hegel misunderstood Kant and Schelling, Marx misunderstood Hegel, Nietzsche misunderstood Christ, Heidegger misunderstood Hegel.... Precisely when one philosopher exerted a key influence upon another, this influence was without exception grounded in a productive misreading—did not the entirety of analytic philosophy emerge from misreading the early Wittgenstein?

Another complication that pertains to philosophy concerns the fact that, often, other disciplines take over (at least part of) the "normal" role of philosophy: in some of the nineteenth-century nations like Hungary or Poland, it was literature that played the role of philosophy (that of articulating the ultimate horizon of meaning of the nation in the process of its full constitution); in the United States today—in the conditions of the predominance of cognitivism and brain studies in philosophy departments—most of "Continental Philosophy" takes place in Departments of Comparative Literature, Cultural Studies, English, French, and German (as they are now saying, if you analyze a rat's vertebra, you are doing philosophy; if you analyze Hegel, you belong to CompLit); in Slovenia during the 1970s, the "dissident" philosophy took place in sociology departments and institutes. There is also the other extreme of philosophy itself taking over the tasks of other academic (or even nonacademic) practices and disciplines: again, in the former Yugoslavia and some other socialist countries, philosophy was one of the spaces of the first articulation of "dissident" political projects—it effectively was "politics pursued with other means" (as Althusser put it apropos of Lenin). So, where did philosophy play its "normal role"? One usually invokes Germany. However, is it not already a commonplace that the extraordinary role of philosophy in German history was grounded in the belatedness of the realization of the German national political project? As Marx already put it (taking his cue from Heine), Germans had their philosophical revolution (German Idealism) because they missed the political revolution (which took place in France). Is, then, there a norm at all? The closest one comes to it is if one looks upon the anemic established academic philosophy like neo-Kantianism one hundred years ago in Germany or French Cartesian epistemology (Leon Brunschvicg, etc.) of the first half of the twentieth century, which was precisely philosophy at its most stale, academic, irrelevant, and "dead." (No wonder that, in 2002, Luc Ferry, a neo-Kantian, was nominated the minister of education in the new center-right French government.) What if, then, there is no "normal role"? What if it is exceptions themselves that retroactively create the illusion of the "norm" they allegedly violate? What if not only, in philosophy, exception is the rule but also what if philosophy—the need for authentic philosophical thought—arises precisely in those moments when (other) parts-constituents of the social edifice cannot play their "proper role?" What if the "proper" space for philosophy *is* these very gaps and interstices opened up by "pathological" displacements in the social edifice?

For this (and other) reasons, Alain Badiou is right in rejecting Lacan's "anti-philosophy." In fact, when Lacan endlessly varies the motif of how

philosophy tries to "fill in the holes," to present a totalizing view of the universe, to cover up all the gaps, ruptures, and inconsistencies (say, in the total self-transparency of self-consciousness)—and how, against philosophy, psychoanalysis asserts the constitutive gap/rupture/inconsistency, and so on and so forth—he simply misses the point of what the most fundamental philosophical gesture is: not to close the gap, but, on the contrary, to open up a radical gap in the very edifice of the universe, the "ontological difference," the gap between the empirical and the transcendental, in which neither of the two levels can be reduced to the other (as we know from Kant, transcendental constitution is a mark of our—human—finitude and has nothing to do with "creating reality"; on the other hand, reality appears to us only within the transcendental horizon, so we cannot generate the emergence of the transcendental horizon from the ontic self-development of reality).[1]

A Lacanian book on Deleuze cannot ignore all these facts. Consequently, *Organs without Bodies* is not a "dialogue" between these two theories but something quite different: an attempt to trace the contours of an *encounter* between two incompatible fields. An encounter cannot be reduced to symbolic exchange: what resonates in it, over and above the symbolic exchange, is the echo of a traumatic impact. While dialogues are commonplace, encounters are rare.

So, why Deleuze? In the past decade, Deleuze emerged as the central reference of contemporary philosophy: notions like "resisting multitude," "nomadic subjectivity," the "anti-Oedipal" critique of psychoanalysis, and so on are the common currency of today's academia—not to mention the fact that Deleuze more and more serves as the theoretical foundation of today's anti-globalist Left and its resistance to capitalism. *Organs without Bodies* here goes "against the current": its starting premise is that, beneath this Deleuze (the popular image of Deleuze based on the reading of the books he coauthored with Felix Guattari), there is another Deleuze, much closer to psychoanalysis and Hegel, a Deleuze whose consequences are much more shattering. This book therefore starts by discerning the inner tension of Deleuze's thought between *Anti-Oedipus* and *The Logic of Sense,* between the Deleuze who celebrated the productive multitude of Becoming against the reified order of being and the Deleuze of the sterility of the incorporeal becoming of the Sense-Event. The consequences of this tension are then deployed with regard to three principal domains: science, art (cinema), and politics (it is not difficult to discern in these three domains the good old triad of the True, the

[1] Perhaps, along these lines, one should even take the risk of proposing that psychoanalysis—the subject's confrontation with its innermost fantasmatic kernel—is no longer to be accepted as the ultimate gesture of subjective authenticity.

Beautiful, and the Good).[2] With regard to science, the possible links between psychoanalysis, on one side, and cognitivism and the brain sciences, on the other side, are explored. With regard to cinema, the analysis of a series of formal procedures in classical and contemporary Hollywood films (from Hitchcock to *Fight Club*) is used to deploy how the notion of the "organ without a body" (which inverts the Deleuzian notion of the body without organs) plays a key role not only in formal analysis but also with regard to the new figures of revolutionary subjectivity. And, finally, in relation to politics, the deadlock and impotence of the popular "Deleuzian politics" is exposed, and the contours of a different "Deleuzian politics" are outlined. The target of critique here involves those aspects of Deleuzianism that, while masquerading as radical chic, effectively transform Deleuze into an ideologist of today's "digital capitalism."

*

During the shooting of David Lean's *Doctor Zhivago* in a Madrid suburb in 1964, a crowd of Spanish statists had to sing the "Internationale" in a scene involving a mass demonstration. The movie team was astonished to discover that they all knew the song and were singing it with such a passion that the Francoist police intervened, thinking that they were dealing with a real political manifestation. Even more, when, late in the evening (the scene was to take place in darkness), people living in the nearby houses heard the echoes of the song, they opened up bottles and started to dance in the street, wrongly presuming that Franco had died and the Socialists had taken power.

This book is dedicated to those magic moments of illusory freedom (which, in a way, were precisely not simply illusory) and to the hopes thwarted by the return to "normal" reality.

[2] Especially with regard to the philosophical aspect of the book, I would like to thank Adrian Johnston for many helpful critical suggestions.

Deleuze

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The Reality of the Virtual

The measure of the true love for a philosopher is that one recognizes traces of his concepts all around in one's daily experience. Recently, while watching again Sergei Eisenstein's *Ivan the Terrible,* I noticed a wonderful detail in the coronation scene at the beginning of the first part: when the two (for the time being) closest friends of Ivan pour golden coins from the large plates onto his newly anointed head, this veritable rain of gold cannot but surprise the spectator by its magically excessive character—even after we see the two plates almost empty, we cut to Ivan's head on which golden coins "nonrealistically" continue to pour in a continuing flow. Is this excess not very "Deleuzian"? Is it not the excess of the pure flow of becoming over its corporeal cause, of the virtual over the actual?

The first determination that comes to mind apropos of Deleuze is that he is the philosopher of the Virtual—and the first reaction to it should be to oppose Deleuze's notion of the Virtual to the all-pervasive topic of virtual reality: what matters to Deleuze is not virtual reality but *the reality of the virtual* (which, in Lacanian terms, is the Real). Virtual Reality in itself is a rather miserable idea: that of imitating reality, of reproducing its experience in an artificial medium. The reality of the Virtual, on the other hand, stands for the reality of the Virtual as such, for its real effects and consequences. Let us take an attractor in mathematics: all positive lines or points in its sphere of attraction only approach it in an endless fashion, never reaching its form—the existence of this form is purely virtual, being nothing more than the shape toward which lines and points tend. However, precisely as such, the virtual is the Real of this field: the

immovable focal point around which all elements circulate. Is not this Virtual ultimately the Symbolic as such? Let us take symbolic authority: to function as an effective authority, it has to remain not-fully-actualized, an eternal threat.

Perhaps, the ontological difference between the Virtual and the Actual is best captured by the shift in the way quantum physics conceives of the relationship between particles and their interactions: in an initial moment, it appears as if first (ontologically, at least) there are particles interacting in the mode of waves, oscillations, and so forth; then, in a second moment, we are forced to enact a radical shift of perspective—the primordial ontological fact are the waves themselves (trajectories, oscillations), and particles are nothing but the nodal points in which different waves intersect.[1] This brings us to the constitutive ambiguity of the relationship between actual and virtual: (1) the human eye *reduces* the perception of light; it actualizes light in a certain way (perceiving certain colors, etc.), a rose in a different way, a bat in a different way. . . . The flow of light "in itself" is nothing actual, but, rather, the pure virtuality of infinite possibilities actualized in a multitude of ways; (2) on the other hand, the human eye expands perception—it inscribes what it "really sees" into the intricate network of memories and anticipations (like Proust with the taste of madeleine), it can develop new perceptions, and so forth.[2]

The genius of Deleuze resides in his notion of "transcendental empiricism": in contrast to the standard notion of the transcendental as the formal conceptual network that structures the rich flow of empirical data, *the Deleuzian "transcendental" is infinitely RICHER than reality*—it is the infinite potential field of virtualities out of which reality is actualized. The term "transcendental" is used here in the strict philosophical sense of the a priori conditions of possibility of our experience of constituted reality. The paradoxical coupling of opposites (transcendental + empirical) points toward a field of experience beyond (or, rather, beneath) the

[1] The genealogy of Deleuze's concepts is often strange and unexpected—say, his assertion of the Anglo-Saxon notion of external relations is clearly indebted to the religious problematic of grace. The missing link here is Alfred Hitchcock, the English Catholic, in whose films a change in relations between persons, in no way rooted in their characters, totally external to them, changes everything, deeply affects them (say, when, at the beginning of *North-by-Northwest,* Thornhill is wrongly identified as Kaplan). Chabrol and Rohmer's Catholic reading of Hitchcock (in their *Hitchcock,* 1954) deeply influenced Deleuze since, in the Jansenist tradition, it focuses precisely on "grace" as a contingent divine intervention that has nothing to do with the inherent virtues and qualities of the affected characters.

[2] And is this ambiguity not homologous to the ontological paradox of quantum physics? The very "hard reality" that emerges out of the fluctuation through the collapse of the wave-function, is the outcome of observation, that is, of the intervention of consciousness. Consciousness is thus not the domain of potentiality, multiple options, and so forth, as opposed to hard single reality—reality *previous* to its perception is fluid-multiple-open, and conscious perception reduces this spectral, preontological multiplicity to one ontologically, fully constituted, reality.

experience of constituted or perceived reality. We remain here within the field of consciousness: Deleuze defines the field of transcendental empiricism as "a pure a-subjective current of consciousness, an impersonal prereflexive consciousness, a qualitative duration of consciousness without self."[3] No wonder that (one of) his reference(s) here is the late Fichte, who tried to think the absolute process of self-positing as a flow of Life beyond the opposites of subject and object: "A life is the immanence of immanence, absolute immanence: it is sheer power, utter beatitude. Insofar as he overcomes the aporias of the subject and the object Fichte, in his later philosophy, presents the transcendental field as a life which does not depend on a Being and is not subjected to an Act: an absolute immediate consciousness whose very activity no longer refers back to a being but ceaselessly posits itself in a life."[4]

Perhaps Jackson Pollock is the ultimate "Deleuzian painter": does his action-painting not directly render this flow of pure becoming, the impersonal-unconscious life energy, the encompassing field of virtuality out of which determinate paintings can actualize themselves, this field of pure intensities with no meaning to be unearthed by interpretation? The cult of Pollock's personality (heavy-drinking American macho) is secondary with regard to this fundamental feature: far from "expressing" his personality, his works "sublate" or cancel it.[5] The first example that comes to mind in the domain of cinema is Sergei Eisenstein: if his early silent films are remembered primarily on account of their practice of montage in its different guises, from the "montage of attractions" to "intellectual montage" (i.e., if their accent is on cuts), then his "mature" sound films shift the focus onto the continuous proliferation of what Lacan called *sinthomes,* of the traces of affective intensities. Recall, throughout both parts of *Ivan the Terrible* the motif of the thunderous explosion of rage that is continuously morphed and thus assumes different guises, from the thunderstorm itself to the explosions of uncontrolled fury. Although it may at first appear to be an expression of Ivan's psyche, its sound detaches itself from Ivan and starts to float around, passing from one to another person or to a state not attributable to any diegetic person. This motif should be interpreted not as an "allegory" with a fixed "deeper meaning" but as a pure "mechanic" intensity beyond meaning (this is what

[3] Gilles Deleuze, "Immanence: une vie . . . ," quoted from John Marks, *Gilles Deleuze* (London: Pluto Press, 1998), p. 29.

[4] Deleuze, op. cit., p. 30. One is tempted to oppose to this Deleuzian absolute immanence of the flow of Life, as the *presubjective consciousness,* the Freudo-Lacanian *unconscious subject* ($) as the agency of the death drive.

[5] So what about the opposition Pollock-Rothko? Does it not correspond to the opposition of Deleuze versus Freud/Lacan? The virtual field of potentialities versus the minimal difference, the gap between background and figure?

Eisenstein aimed at in his idiosyncratic use of the term "operational"). Other such motives echo and reverse each other, or, in what Eisenstein called "naked transfer," jump from one to another expressive medium (say, when an intensity gets too strong in the visual medium of mere shapes, it jumps and explodes in movement—then in sound, or in color...). For example, Kirstin Thompson points out how the motif of a single eye in *Ivan* is a "floating motif," in itself strictly meaningless, but a repeated element that can, according to context, acquire a range of expressive implications (joy, suspicion, surveillance, quasi-godlike omniscience).[6] And the most interesting moments in *Ivan* occur when such motifs seem to explode their preordained space. Not only do they acquire a multitude of ambiguous meanings no longer covered by an encompassing thematic or ideological agenda but also, in the most excessive moments, such a motif seems even to have no meaning at all, instead just floating there as a provocation, as a challenge to find the meaning that would tame its sheer provocative power.

Among contemporary filmmakers, the one who lends himself ideally to a Deleuzian reading is Robert Altman, whose universe, best exemplified by his masterpiece *Short Cuts,* is effectively that of contingent encounters between a multitude of series, a universe in which different series communicate and resonate at the level of what Altman himself refers to as "subliminal reality" (meaningless mechanic shocks, encounters, and impersonal intensities that precede the level of social meaning).[7] So, in *Nashville,* when violence explodes at the end (the murder of Barbara Jean at the concert), this explosion, although unprepared and unaccounted for at the level of the explicit narrative line, is nonetheless experienced as fully justified, since the ground for it was laid at the level of signs circulating in the film's "subliminal reality." And is it not that, when we hear the songs in *Nashville,* Altman directly mobilizes what Brian Massumi calls the "autonomy of affect"?[8] That is to say, we totally misread *Nashville* if we locate the songs within the global horizon of the ironico-critical depiction of the vacuity and ritualized commercial alienation of the universe of American country music: on the contrary, we are allowed to—even seduced into—enjoy fully the music on its own, in its affective intensity, independent of Altman's obvious critico-ideological project. (Incidentally, the same goes for the songs from Brecht's great

[6] See Kirstin Thompson, *Eisenstein's "Ivan the Terrible": A Neoformalist Analysis* (Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press, 1981).

[7] See Robert T. Self, *Robert Altman's Subliminal Reality* (Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 2002).

[8] See Brian Massumi, "The Autonomy of Affect," in *Deleuze: A Critical Reader,* edited by Paul Patton (Oxford: Blackwell, 1996).

pieces—their musical pleasure is independent of their ideological message.) What this means is that one should also avoid the temptation of reducing Altman to a poet of American alienation, rendering the silent despair of everyday lives. There is another Altman, namely, the one of opening oneself to joyful contigent encounters. Along the same lines as Deleuze and Guattari's reading of Kafka's universe of the Absence of the inaccessible and elusive transcendent Center (Castle, Court, God) as the Presence of multiple passages and transformations, one is tempted to read the Altmanian "despair and anxiety" as the deceiving obverse of the more affirmative immersion into the multitude of subliminal intensities. Of course, this underlying plane can also contain the obscene superego subtext of the "official" ideological message—recall the notorious "Uncle Sam" recruiting poster for the U.S. Army:

> This is an image whose demands, if not desires, seem absolutely clear, focussed on a determinate object: it wants "you," that is, the young men of the proper age for military service. The immediate aim of the picture looks like a version of the Medusa effect: that is, it "hails" the viewer, verbally, and tries to transfix him with the directness of its gaze and (its most wonderful pictorial feature) the foreshortened pointing hand and finger that single out the viewer, accusing, designating, and commanding the viewer. But the desire to transfix is only a transitory and momentary goal. The longer-range motive is to move and mobilize the viewer, to send the beholder on to "the nearest recruiting station," and ultimately overseas to fight and possibly die for his country.
>
> . . . Here the contrast with the German and Italian posters is clarifying. These are posters in which young soldiers hail their brothers, call them to the brotherhood of honorable death in battle. *Uncle* Sam, as his name indicates, has a more tenuous, indirect relation to the potential recruit. He is an older man who lacks the youthful vigor for combat, and perhaps even more important, lacks the direct blood connection that a figure of the fatherland would evoke. He asks young men to go fight and die in a war in which neither he nor his sons will participate. There are no "sons" of Uncle Sam. . . . Uncle Sam himself is sterile, a kind of abstract, pasteboard figure who has no body, no blood, but who impersonates the nation and calls for other men's sons to donate their bodies and their blood.
>
> So what does this picture want? A full analysis would take us deep into the political unconscious of a nation that is nominally imagined as a disembodied abstraction, an Enlightenment polity of laws and not men, principles and not blood relationships, and actually embodied as a place where old white men send young men and women of all races (including a disproportionately high number of colored people) to fight their wars. What this real and imagined nation lacks is meat—bodies and blood—and what it sends to obtain them is a hollow man, a meat supplier, or perhaps just an artist.[9]

[9] Tom Mitchell, "What Do Pictures *Really* Want?" *October,* no. 77 (summer 1996): 64–66.

The first thing to do here is to add to this series the famous Soviet poster "Motherland is calling you," in which the interpellator is a mature strong woman. We thus move from the American imperialist Uncle through European Brothers to the Communist Mother—here we have the split, constitutive of interpellation, between law and superego (or want and desire). What a picture like this *wants* is not the same as what it *desires:* while it wants us to participate in the noble struggle for freedom, it desires blood, the proverbial pound of our flesh (no wonder the elder sterile "Uncle [not Father] Sam" can be deciphered as a Jewish figure, along the lines of the Nazi reading of American military interventions: "the Jewish plutocracy wants the blood of the innocent Americans to feed their interests"). In short, it would be ridiculous to say that "Uncle Sam desires you": Uncle Sam wants you, but he desires the partial object in you, your pound of flesh. When a superego call WANTS (and enjoins) you to do it, to gather the strength and succeed, the secret message of DESIRE is "I know you will not be able to achieve it, so I desire you to fail and to gloat in your failure!" This superego character, confirmed by the Yankee Doodle association (recall the fact that superego figures inextricably mix obscene ferocity and clownish comedy), is further sustained by the contradictory character of its call: it first wants to arrest our movement and fixate our gaze, so that, surprised, we stare at it; in a second moment, it wants us to follow its call and go to the nearest conscription office—as if, after stopping us, it mockingly addresses us: "Why do you stare at me like an idiot? Didn't you get my point? Go to the nearest conscription post!" In the arrogant gesture typical of the mocking characteristics of the superego, it laughs at our very act of taking seriously its first call.[10]

When Eric Santner told me about a game his father played with him when he was a small boy (the father showed, opened up in front of him, his palm, in which there were a dozen or so different coins; the father then closed his palm after a couple of seconds and asked the boy how much money there was in his palm—if the small Eric guessed the exact sum, the father gave him the money), this anecdote provoked in me an explosion of deep and uncontrollable anti-Semitic satisfaction expressed in wild laughter: "You see, this is how Jews really teach their children! Is this not a perfect case of your own theory of a proto-history which accompanies the explicit symbolic history? At the level of explicit history, your father was probably telling you noble stories about Jewish suffering and the universal horizon of humanity, but his true secret teaching was

[10] What, then, more generally, does a picture want? One is tempted to apply here the good old Lacanian triad of ISR: at the level of the Imaginary, it is a lure that wants to seduce us into aesthetic pleasure; at the level of the Symbolic, it calls for its interpretation; at the level of the Real, it endeavors to shock us, to cause us to avert our eyes or to fixate our gaze.

contained in those practical jokes about how to quickly deal with money." Anti-Semitism effectively *is* part of the ideologocal obscene underside of most of us.

And one finds a similar obscene subtext even where one would not expect it—in some texts that are commonly perceived as feminist. To confront this obscene "plague of fantasies" that persists at the level of "subliminal reality" at its most radical, suffice it to (re)read Margaret Atwood's *The Handmaid's Tale,* the distopia about the "Republic of Gilead," a new state on the East Coast of the United States that emerged when the Moral Majority took over. The ambiguity of the novel is radical: its "official" aim is, of course, to present as actually realized the darkest conservative tendencies in order to warn us about the threats of Christian fundamentalism—the evoked vision is expected to give rise to horror in us. However, what strikes the eye is the utter *fascination* with this imagined universe and its invented rules. Fertile woman are allocated to those privileged members of the new nomenklatura whose wives cannot bear children—forbidden to read, deprived of their names (they are called after the man to whom they belong: the heroine is Offred—"of Fred"), they serve as receptacles of insemination. The more we read the novel, the more it becomes clear that the fantasy we are reading is not that of the Moral Majority but that of feminist liberalism itself: an exact mirror image of the fantasies about the sexual degeneration in our megalopolises that haunt members of the Moral Majority. So, what the novel displays is desire—not of the Moral Majority but the hidden desire of feminist liberalism itself.

Becoming versus History

The ontological opposition between Being and Becoming that underpins Deleuze's notion of the virtual is a radical one in that its ultimate reference is *pure becoming without being* (as opposed to the metaphysical notion of pure being without becoming). This pure becoming is not a particular becoming *of* some corporeal entity, a passage of this entity from one to another state, but a becoming-it-itself, thoroughly extracted from its corporeal base. Since the predominant temporality of Being is that of the present (with past and future as its deficient modes), the pure becoming-without-being means that one should sidestep the present—it never "actually occurs," it is "always forthcoming and already past."[11] As such, pure becoming suspends sequentiality and directionality: say, in an actual process of becoming, the critical point of temperature (0 degrees Celsius) always has a direction (water either freezes or melts), whereas,

[11] Gilles Deleuze, *The Logic of Sense* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1990), p. 80.

considered as pure becoming extracted from its corporeality, this point of passage is not a passage from one to another state but a "pure" passage, neutral as to its directionality, perfectly symmetric—for instance, a thing is simultaneously getting larger (that it was) and smaller (than it will be). And is not the ultimate example of the poetry of pure becoming the Zen poems that aim merely to render the fragility of the pure event extracted from its causal context?

The Foucault closest to Deleuze is therefore the Foucault of *The Archeology of Knowledge,* his underrated key work delineating the ontology of utterances as pure language events: not elements of a structure, not attributes of subjects who utter them, but events that emerge, function within a field, and disappear. To put it in Stoic terms, Foucault's discourse analysis studies *lekta,* utterances as pure events, focusing on the inherent conditions of their emergence (as the concatenation of events themselves) and not on their inclusion in the context of historical reality. This is why the Foucault of *The Archeology of Knowledge* is as far as possible from any form of historicism, of locating events in their historical context—on the contrary, Foucault *abstracts* them from their reality and its historical causality and studies the *immanent* rules of their emergence. What one should bear in mind here is that Deleuze is *not* an evolutionary historicist; his opposition of Being and Becoming should not deceive us. He is not simply arguing that all stable, fixed entities are just coagulations of the all-encompassing flux of Life—why not? The reference to the notion of *time* is crucial here. Let us recall how Deleuze (with Guattari), in his description of becoming in/of philosophy, explicitly opposes becoming and history:

> Philosophical time is thus a grandiose time of coexistence that does not exclude the before and after but *superimposes* them in a stratigraphic order. It is an infinite becoming of philosophy that crosscuts its history without being confused with it. The life of philosophers, and what is most external to their work, conforms to the ordinary laws of succession; but their proper names coexist and shine as luminous points that take us through the components of a concept once more or as the cardinal points of a stratum or layer that continually come back to us, like dead stars whose light is brighter than ever.[12]

The paradox is thus that transcendental becoming inscribes itself into the order of positive being, of constituted reality, *in the guise of its very opposite,* of a static superimposition, of a crystallized freeze of historical development. This Deleuzian eternity is, of course, not simply outside

[12] Gilles Deleuze and Felix Guattari, *What Is Philosophy?* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1994), p. 59.